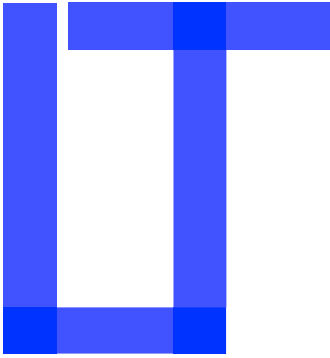




# Luisa Torres Varas

**Geospatial Analyst  
Architect  
Photographer**

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**address:** mexican  
**date of birth:** 04 march 2000  
**marital status:** single  
**residence permit in Switzerland:** no

Her work navigates between big and small data, the intimate scale of lived data, working at the intersection of qualitative and quantitative research, seeking to make complex territorial dynamics legible and understandable at different scales. In that legibility, she finds a bridge between design, research, and data-driven decision-making: a tool that informs and moves toward action, in service of communities and territories resisting unequal power dynamics.

## education

**Master's in Advanced Urbanism and Data Analysis**  
Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024–2026)

**Mobility for Everyone: Gender, Age, and Mobility**  
Escuela de Movilidad Sostenible (2024) 60hrs

**Walkable Cities: Pedestrians, Public Space, and Universal Accessibility**  
Escuela de Movilidad Sostenible (2023) 60hrs

**Architecture – Creative Studies**  
Tecnológico de Monterrey, Querétaro Campus (2019–2023)

**University Exchange**  
Jönköping University, Sweden (01-07/ 2022)  
Concentration in Urban Space

**Linguistics and Cultural Exchange**  
Vienna, Austria (2017-2018)

**Linguistics and Cultural Exchange**  
Rhode Island, USA (2014-2015)

## Languages

-Spanish Native  
-English C1 Toefl IBT  
-German A2

## Hard skills

-Geospatial & Remote Sensing  
-Programming & Data Analysis  
-Machine Learning & AI  
-Data Visualization  
-Parametric & 3D  
-Workflow & Automation

## Work Experience

**Dérive Lab** | between research, art, architecture, urban design, and other disciplines  
- Junior Designer: 3D modeling, visual documentation, exhibition assembly, and development of conceptual and communication materials for interdisciplinary projects.

**External Reference** | between research, architecture, art, and digital tools  
- Research and Publications Assistant.

**Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia** | educational and architectural research center in Barcelona  
- Research and Teaching Assistant in the Data-driven Urban Design Studio: Data, Design & Spatial Justice in Action.

## Projects

**Beyond the Data Point: A Counter-Cartography of People on the Move through Mexico's Vertical Border** | Master's Thesis at IAAC (2026)  
Research focused on developing counter-mapping methodologies to spatialize testimonies of migrants using LLMs, critically addressing their structural biases. The work transforms migratory narratives into forms of spatial and relational knowledge capable of revealing invisibilized patterns of violence and amplifying the collective voice of migratory experiences.

**External Reference's DNA** | External Reference & Actar Publishers (2026)  
Research on the relationship between affective states evoked by architectural spaces and their quantifiable spatial qualities through artificial intelligence and computer vision, based on the analysis of the photographic archive of the studio's projects.



## Hobbies

Photography  
Futball  
Tennis

## Soft skills

-Critical Thinking  
-Cross-scale translation  
-Interdisciplinary fluency  
-Visual communication  
-Social and human sensibility

**Quito in Transition** | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2025)  
Spatial analysis of urban mobility with a feminist perspective, featuring a collaborative web map and catalogue of interventions to empower women users of public transport in Quito.

**Stolen River: Unmasking Nile's Land Grabbed Territories** | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2025)  
Satellite detection of land grabbing in the Nile basin using Python, computer vision, and Sentinel imagery, visualized on an open-access interactive web platform.

**Layers of Besòs** | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024)  
Urban research on insecurity, identity, and economy in Besòs, with a public space intervention proposal using generative AI and participatory design.

**Metabolic Rift: The Ever Changing Landscape of Flooding** | Institute for Advanced Architecture of Catalonia (2024)  
Research on flood risk associated with DANA episodes and the absorption capacity of different vegetation types in Mediterranean cities, integrating historical cartography, parametric mapping, and geospatial modeling with Grasshopper.

**Interface to the Future** | Dérive Lab (2024)  
Art, science, and technology project that explores and makes Anthropocene dynamics visible through workshops, walks, and exhibition devices.

**Devenires del Consumo** | Tecnológico de Monterrey & INAH (2023)  
Critical cartography of the Querétaro River through the analysis of 759 plastic residues, linking global production, local consumption, and territorial impact.

## Awards / Recognition

**Community Award: People, Places and Cultures Award** IAAC (2025). Outstanding Performance

**Presentation at the University of Miami and 10Design/SB Architects**  
Selected Thesis Project

**Exhibition at the Museo de la Ciudad Querétaro**  
Devenires del Consumo Research

## Portfolio link!

<https://luisatvaras.github.io/portfolio2026/>